MALL SURVEY – PROJECT I

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I MBA B

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1. OBJECTIVE

- To observe the nature of the mall
- To observe the customers and shopkeepers behaviour
- To analyse and compare the activities in mall

2. INTRODUCTION

Shopping Malls in Chennai are known for its diverse products and high prices. The showroom offers wide range of colourful collections for every occasion and for all classes of customers. We visited 5 of the most popular malls in Chennai and made an analysis based on the observation and came up with a conclusion considering the non-statistical comparison.

3. SUMMARY OF MALL VISITS

Our observations on the visits to Phoneix , AMPA , City Center , Express Avenue and Spenzer Plaza were summarised as follows.

3.1 PHONEIX MALL

Visited on : 13.2.14 (Thursday) , 5 PM – 8 PM

Phoneix Mall was the first mall that we visited in our IV. Be the wide spacing or the perfect parking lot or the decorations Phoneix indeed stands unique.

3.1.1 Location : Velachery, Chennai.

3.1.2 Size and Structure

Being the newly constructed mall, the works are not finished yet in the top part. Apart form that the Mall stands majestic and gigantic. The outer looks and the advertisement boards add charm to it. One thing we felt was that since the Phoneix group

was already into this mall business in other cities like Bangalore & Mumbai, they were well versed in building attractive mall.

3.1.3 Nature

Phoenix mall seems to be having a perfect blend of showcasing and purchasing sort of shops each balancing the other.

3.1.4 Shops nature

At Phoenix Market City shopping turns into an extravagant experience as all sort of internationally comparable with the best global and local brands are available. From gourmet goodies to off the runway fashion, from luxury accessories to the latest electronics, from wedding shopping to pampering ourselves, every aspect is perfectly covered for our pleasure. But only few shops had stuffs at affordable rate. Meanwhile by the time we visited many shops had discount offers. Few more shops are displaying stuffs like advertisements as they were all premium kind of goods. On the day we went Mercedes Benz was parked inside the mall for promotion.

There were also entertainment options like games and movies. No wonder a person who enters the mall morning has lots of ways to spend time till evening (if he has a fat wallet). The food court was perfect and the prices seemed to be reasonable and there are varieties of shops to choose from. WE also noticed that few shops are vacant and is left for new shops. There was a little super market inside set up by big bazzar which undoubtedly pulls housewives there directly. Total number of shops would be around 400.

3.1.5 Customer nature

Customers here were mostly window shoppers as we observed when compared to the people who were actually buying. Many seemed to be just going around with friends with snacks and stuffs. Still some people came with preplanned things to buy and straight

away zoomed into the shops. Few were wandering, looking for discounts and then entering shops.

3.1.6 Promotional activities

Several promotional decorations were there, pulling the crowd's attention and thereby making them notice the sponsor which turns out to be a free ad.

3.1.7 Facilities

The touch screen display map of phoenix mall giving directions is something to be appreciated. The restrooms were spacious and the escalator facilities were all perfect. At any moment there wasn't any crowd waiting to move up or down the escalators. The shop alignment itself made us feel pleasing and gave us a gist of all shops in a wing no matter from which position we look at them. To us Phoenix is the best mall ever visited.

3.1.8 Service

The shopkeepers in food court were treating customers with courtesy. The showroom owners were also patient over the window shoppers and gave them detailed

information for their queries even though they recognized that they have no intention to buy. There were also several servicers in restrooms. Even if we wash face they immediately clean the sinks after we leave. The place was hygienic. The service was way too good and we hope it's not just because of that that it is a newly established mall.

3.1.9 Personal view

A clever fusion of entertainment options with business seems to the secret of this mall. No wonder that they have observed all the existing malls in Chennai and have implemented all the missing out facilities. Also being the youngest mall of all they will have to continue being the way they are now to pull the crowd. There was no restriction to take photographs around and nor did the shopkeepers treat the window shoppers odd. The food court was perfect without any card system and also many shops were provided discounts and this added much crowd to the mall. Summing up it indeed was a wonderful experience. It kind of looked like a little high tech – city.

3.2AMPA MALL

3.2.1 Location : Nelson Manickam Rd, Aminjikarai, Chennai,

3.2.2 Visited on : 14.2.14 (Friday) , 6 PM – 8.30 PM

Ampa Skywalk Mall is one of the new malls that add glory to Chennai. Being located in Aminjikarai there is no question for the possibility of crowdedness.

3.2.3 Size and Structure

The entire mall is spread across an area of around 3.15 lakh sq. feet. The structure outside didn't seem to be unique. But inside it indeed made its mark. The top bridge like structure is something what they call skywalk which later fitted into the mall's name itself.

3.2.4 Nature and theme

AMPA mall is a mixture of shopping, business, entertainment and leisure.

3.2.5 Shops nature

Chennai's first ever PVR cinemas is located in SkyWalk Mall . Chennai's first Hyper Market Tata Star Bazaar was also located here they say. Since we already saw it on Phoneix it didn't attract us that much. A lot of other popular brands and shops such as Landmark, WestSide, Reebok, Adidas, Lee, Wrangler, Coffee Day, Mustard, Health & Glow, etc. are all located in this sprawling mall. The Food Court has varieties of food options and it is called as 'F3'. The mall also has a small 20 room boutique hotel at the fourth floor. Basically, we felt Ampa SkyWalk Mall is one of the few good places in Chennai to roam around. Indeed most

of the stuffs were kind of costly. We didn't notice as many as discount that we found earlier in Phoneix.

Promotion event were conducted in the centre hall with shops present there as sponsors and coupon cards. AS interior decoration there is much worth saying.

3.2.6 Customer nature

Customers here were mostly purchasers than window shoppers. The rest of the people were just roamers and window shoppers. We noticed that a considerable count of people coming here only for movies.

3.2.7 Promotional activities

Several promotional ads were broadcasted in Radio City on 14th February for the special events that were about to be conducted in the mall. Also people were conducting events in the centre ground asking the for volunteers to participate and were giving gifts on spot. Several companies were sponsoring it, thereby it turned up to be a free promotion for the mall as well as the sponsors. Automatically people waiting for one another gather around and such events seem to have good response always.

3.2.8 Facilities

Skywall don't have special facilities as a mall. It goes with the standard facilities. The rest rooms were not that comfortable for refreshing. The escalators presence added charms to the mall but makes customers wait a bit often. We being there first time ended up searching the way down to the fourth floor as the escalator was kind of hidden by the promotional stuffs of the theatre in that floor. This could have been avoided.

3.2.9 Service

The card system for food court doesn't look that good on customer's point of view when compared to the normal cash system in Phoneix Mall as it takes a hell lot of time

buying card and then food. Apart from that the service was good. But food was costing more which we felt unreasonable.

3.2.10Personal view

Photographs were not allowed in the mall often the securities were reminding this and that was kind of annoying. Apart from that interior view of anything visible from anywhere was nice especially it favoured for getting an clear idea about the shops location without any additional notice boards. The escalators were crowded most of the time which resulted in waiting and also the up climbing and down climbing escalators were present in two different places which was not that convenient either. Summing up visiting for a first time it was good, but we doubt whether we would feel the same next time too.

3.3CITY CENTER

City centre is identified to be one of the expensive malls in Chennai. The nearby location of Queen Mary's and beach indeed acts as a part of the source for crowds during weekdays and weekends respectively. It is owned by ETA Star Properties Ltd.

Visited on : 15.2.14 (Saturday) , 6 PM – 8 PM

3.3.1 Size and Structure

It is 10,925 m² in area and has the capacity to park 500 cars at a time. It has five floors of complete range of products and services that makes it a perfect weekend spot. Considering the structure it stands majestic with a fort look.

3.3.2 Nature

On-going around we noticed that , City Centre seems to be a theme based mall where it showcases most of its shops as premium shops meant for only the image building among the customers.

3.3.4 Shops nature

Major brand outlets in the mall include: Adidas, Allen Solly, Health & Glow, Landmark, Wills Lifestyle, Lilliput, Mochi footwear, Van Heusen and Lifestyle. It seems to be one of the most expensive shopping malls in Chennai. But still people were pouring in like anything during weekends. Shopkeepers they don't mind the window shoppers and neither do they answer their queries properly as we observed. As a whole there were around 300 shops, 50 dining establishments.

3.3.5Customer nature

Though all the prices here were high some people come here with a determination to buy something without any specific plan what to buy. Most of them come with a determination of what to buy and head straight to the specific shops. We observed this form a casual conversation among few friends. Also for people who come to beach it acts like a dinner spot. We could observe that most of the customers here were families. Periodic offer days pull more customers than the other days it seemed as few people were enquiring for discounts in accessories shop.

3.3.6 Promotional activities

Several promotional ads were broadcasted in Radio City on 14th February for the special events that were about to be conducted in the mall. Also people were conducting events in the centre ground asking the for volunteers to participate and were giving gifts on spot. Several companies were sponsoring it , thereby it turned up to be a free promotion for the mall as well as the sponsors. On the day we went 2 promotional activities were going on side by side. One for valentine's day and another one for Life insurance

3.3.7 Facilities

The mall also has INOX theatres, a food court with outlets including Copper Chimney, Pizza Hut, Subway, Gangotree, Arabian Hut and KFC, a video arcade for kids, several department stores and confectioners. Main attraction of the mall is its sea side location.

3.3.8 Service

The shopkeepers in food court were neutrally treating customers with courtesy. Waiting for food takes a long time which results is trapped in food court for a long while. Since it had sea view it's wasn't frustrating. In some showrooms shopkeepers show a different face to the customers once they judge that they have not come for purchase.

3.3.9 Personal view

It was a better mall than expected. No wonder that it eats up time so fast while roaming around and also gives so many small stalls to purchase stuffs. The lifts often made people wait. We could witness so may discounts and offers around. Premium shops were not that crowded on the day we visited. The food court is always full. Cheap Icecreams form McDonalds indeed got into almost everybody's hand while leaving. If we carefully chose shops to purchase and were aware of discounts, no wonder we could make a shopping spree in this expensive mall.

3.4 EXPRESS AVENUE

3.4.1 Location : Whites road, Royapettah, Chennai.

3.4.2 Visited on : 16.2.14 (Sunday) , 6.30 PM - 8 PM

Express Avenue is a shopping mall in Chennai promoted by Express Infrastructure, a subsidiary of The Indian Express Group. Stella mary's College and Ethiraj College being located nearby seems to be an advantage for EA .

3.4.3 Size and Structure

South India's second largest mall, is designed keeping in mind the 'shopper-tainment' concept and this green building developed on 11 acres of land has many architecture splendour. It has 4 floors of retail space and is in the process of finishing a building for corporate offices and a hotel.

3.4.4 Nature and theme

Express Avenue hosts a mixture of shopping, business, entertainment and leisure.

3.4.5 Shops nature

EA has a total of 210 premium national and international brands. Accommodating all of them is high class showrooms, the mall offers shoppers an intimate and convenient shopping experience. An extensive array of international fashion brands such as Oliver, Helvitica, Chemistry, Zimson, Giordano, William Penn, Longines, Tag Heuer, Parcos, Samsara, Tie Bar, Rolex, Kenzo, Paul Smith, Swarvoski, Omega, Oviessee, Da Milano, Espirit UCB, Promod, Mango, also can be found here. We also found various range of shops starting from big retailers to self-grooming stalls. Several shops offered discounts for customers and that indeed seemed to be working as we found comparatively more people in such shops.

Food court here attracts the crowd to the top no matter how attractive the showrooms are in the rest of the floors.

3.4.6Customer nature

Customers here were mostly window shoppers as we observed when compared to the people who were actually buying. Many seemed to be just going around with friends with snacks and stuffs. Mostly we observed youths pouring in and out. They all seemed to be like working people who finds this a place for spending time and money on weekends. From their looks we could guess that they might belong to the the income group of 50,000 and above.

3.4.7Promotional activities

Several promotional ads were broadcasted in Radio City on 14th February for the special events that were about to be conducted in the mall. Also people were conducting events in the centre ground asking the for volunteers to participate and were giving gifts on spot. Several companies were sponsoring it , thereby it turned up to be a free promotion for the mall as well as the sponsors. But all of them received good reach form what we observed.

3.4.8 Facilities

The atrium areas allow plenty of natural light into the common area. The centre of the atrium is covered with glass. In all, the mall has 20 + lifts, 30 + escalators and four travelators. The food court called EA Garden, has 20+ counters with several food and beverage options. There are three basement parking lots that can easily accommodate 2000 vehicles.

3.4.9 Service

The shopkeepers in food court were treating customers with courtesy. The showroom owners were also patient over the window shoppers and gave them detailed information for their queries even though they recognized that they have no intention to buy.

3.4.10 Personal view

A clever fusion of entertainment options with eight screen multiplex, Satyam Cinemas screens the latest blockbusters. It hosts some of the most exciting, memorable events for national holidays and festivals, keeping the tradition alive and going out of the way to provide entertainment for mall-hoppers. Summing up it aims to give a whole new shopping experience to die-hard shopaholics.

3.5 SPENCER PLAZA

3.5.1 Location : Mount Road, Aayiram Vilakku, Chennai,

3.5.2Visited on : 16.2.14 (Sunday) 5 PM - 6.30 PM

Spencer being the oldest mall and being located in the heart of the city has the potential to drag maximum crowd but it has lost its charm to the newbies. The closed shops and fewer customers indeed infer this clearly.

3.5.3Size and Structure

Spencer Plaza's whole seemed to be an accumulation of three phases, each phase given in accordance with a naturally lit atrium, and each atrium accreting in size and grandeur. Ceilings of no more than 10 feet in height, and at a width of no more than 15 feet, become ever more impenetrable as crowds begin to accumulate. There is, we presume, a fine line between an up-scale bazaar and a mall to which Spencer Plaza dangles over.

3.5.4 Nature and theme

Like swimming underwater, one can explore these backward caverns only so long before a return to an atrium for fresh air and reorientation is necessary. They could have been presented well.

3.5.5 Shops nature

The spencer has a number of stores dealing in goods of many local brands, as well as major brands. It also has retail shops of many of the foremost brands in Jewellery, products, and Clothes etc. The sizes of most shops are quite demure, giving a density of doors Jacobs herself would find pleasing. There is variety; however, as large international labels about local arts and crafts dealers provide both a sense of scale and value. An interior city of three stories results- illuminating contrast, warranting density, and strangely inviting intrigue. However we found few shops closed.

3.5.6 Customer nature

Customers here are often the real purchasers and the window shoppers here are less in number. Even though it has lost its charm to the newbies people from nearby areas show up.

3.5.7 Promotional activities

The legacy of being the very first mall ever still there is an evergreen image for the mall.

3.5.8 Facilities

This mall also provides accommodation for the offices for many MNC's and BPO's.

3.5.9 Service

The service was good and the customers were treated neither with too much courtesy nor with too much ‘don’t care’ attitude.

3.5.10 Personal view

Though many malls opened in the city, the glamour of this mall has not completely went down giving place for around 4000 people on weekdays and 6000 people on weekends to spend their time. Spencer Plaza remains the second place for the Chennai people near to the Marina to hang out. We could say that once the Chennai stopped here.

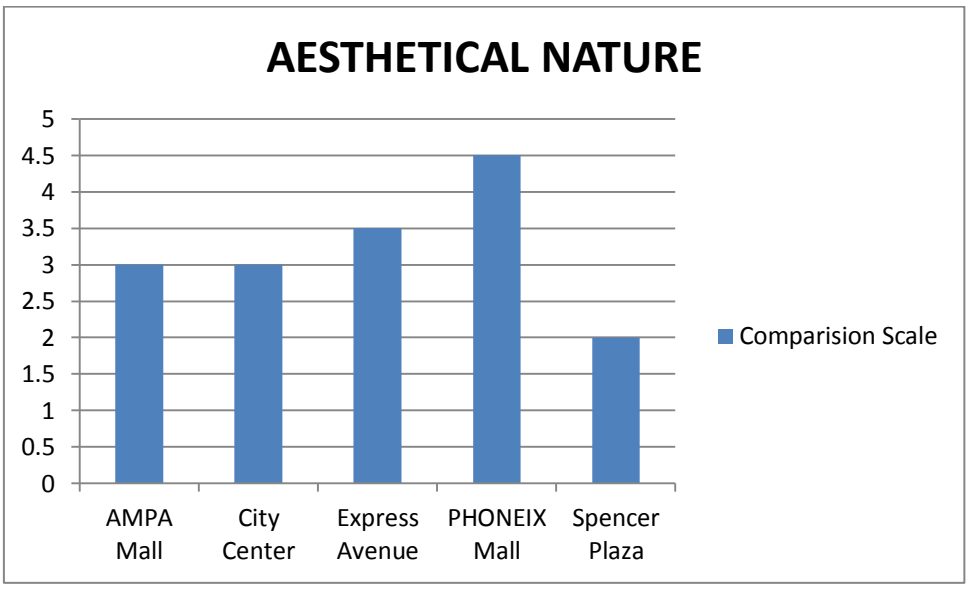
4. COMPARISION

On comparing the experiences we gained in the 5 malls we came up with the following conclusion. The comparisons were done on a scale of 5 where the scale considered is given as follows:

Scale	Status
1	Very Bad
2	Bad
3	Neither bad nor good
4	Good
5	Very Good

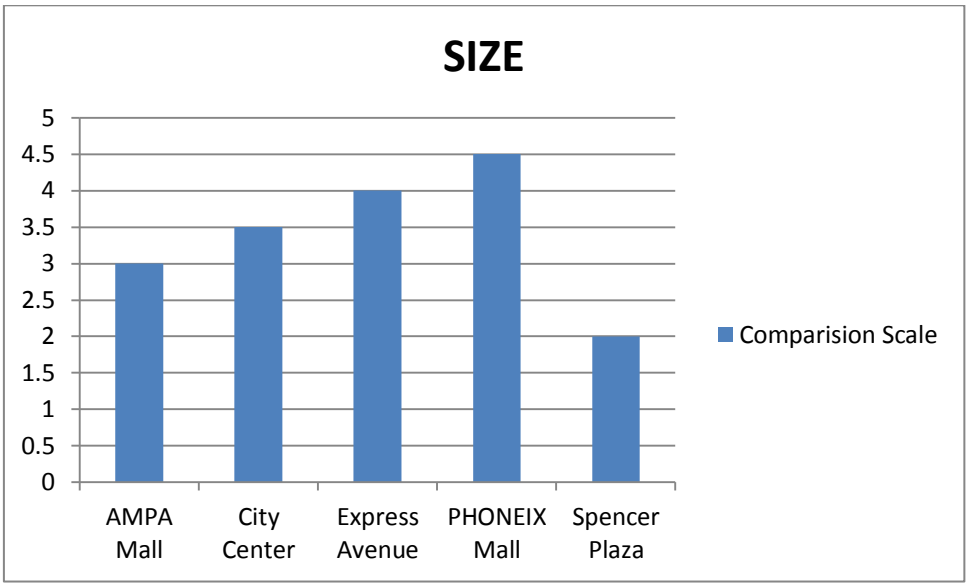
4.1 Aesthetical nature

Based on the appearance, structure, interior decoration of mall, shops arrangement and interior decoration of the shops we came up with the following conclusion.



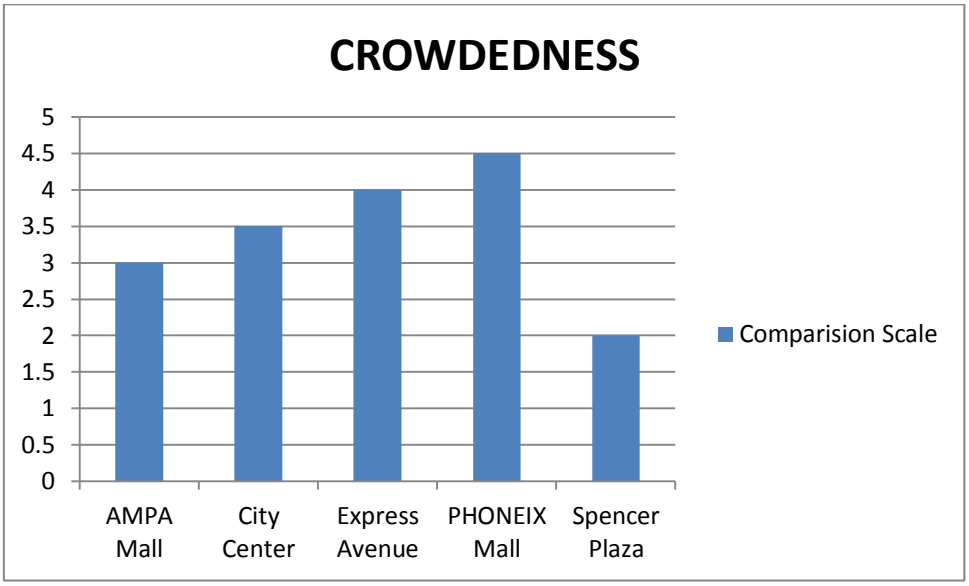
4.2 Size

The area coverage in ft square is being compared here.



4.3 Crowdedness

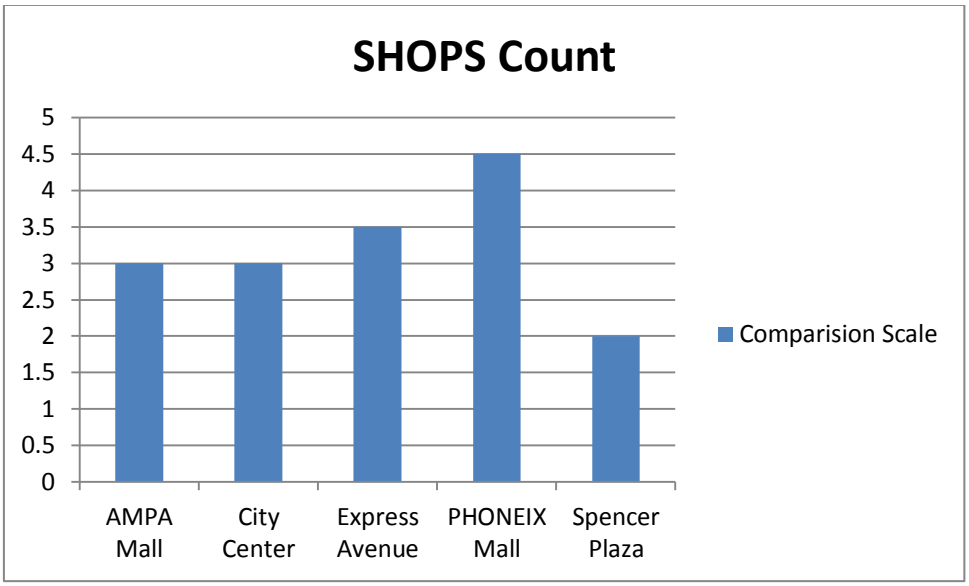
People density on the day observed is being compared here.



4.4Shops

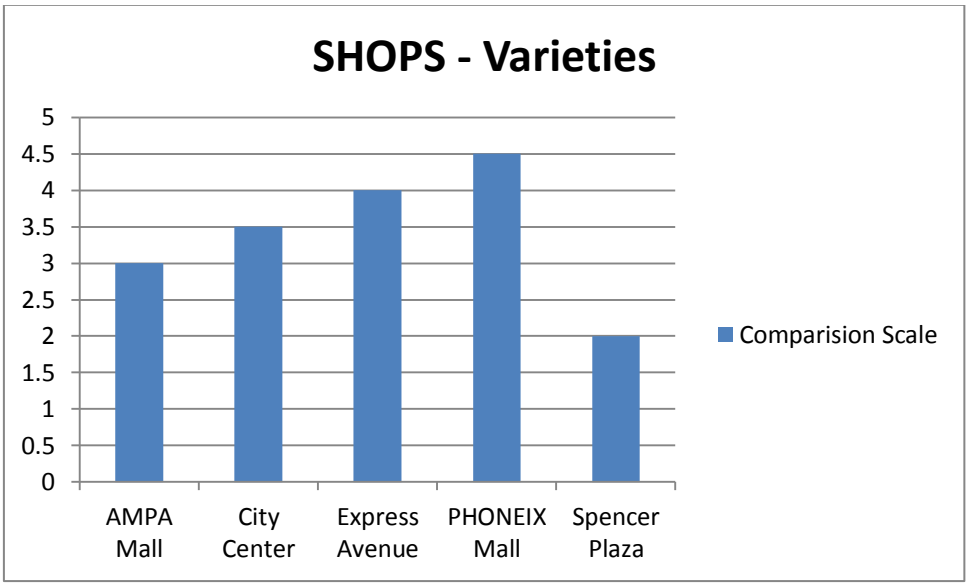
4.4.1Count

The number of shops accommodated is being compared here.



4.4.2 Varieties

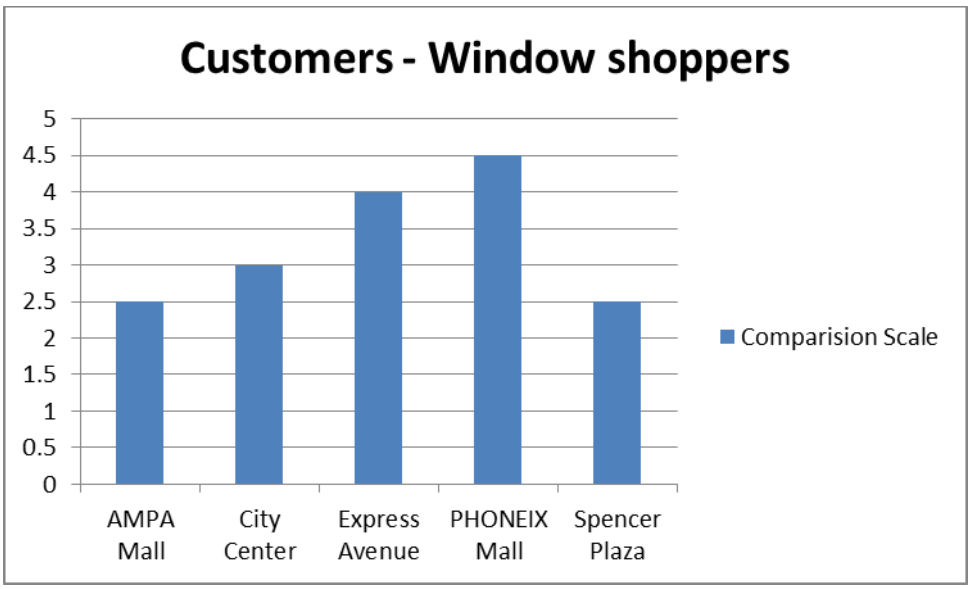
The count of different range of products and services that were offered and delivered are compared here.



4.5 Customers

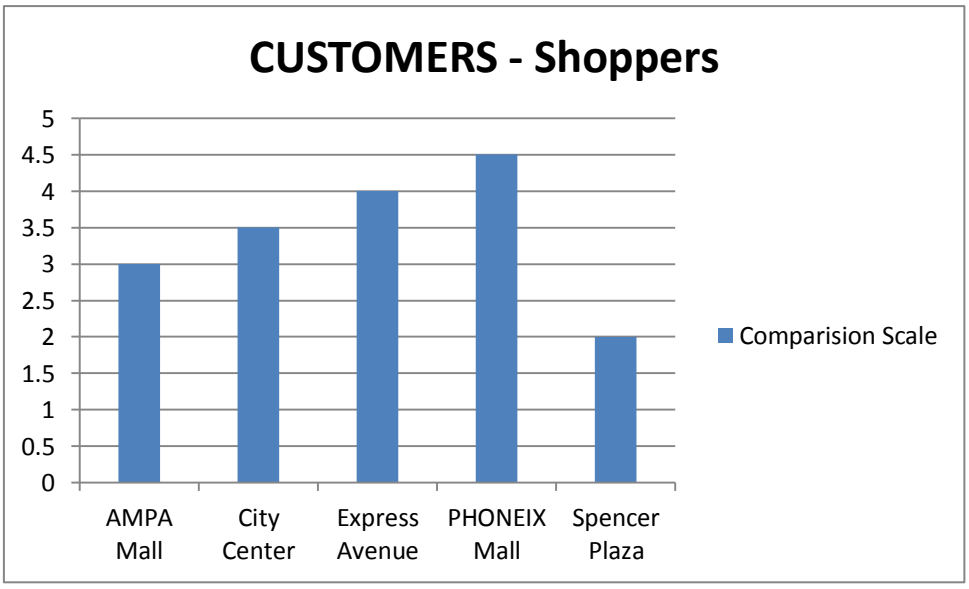
4.5.1 Window shoppers

Number of people we observed doing window shopping in each mall were pictured comparatively.



4.5.2 Purchasers

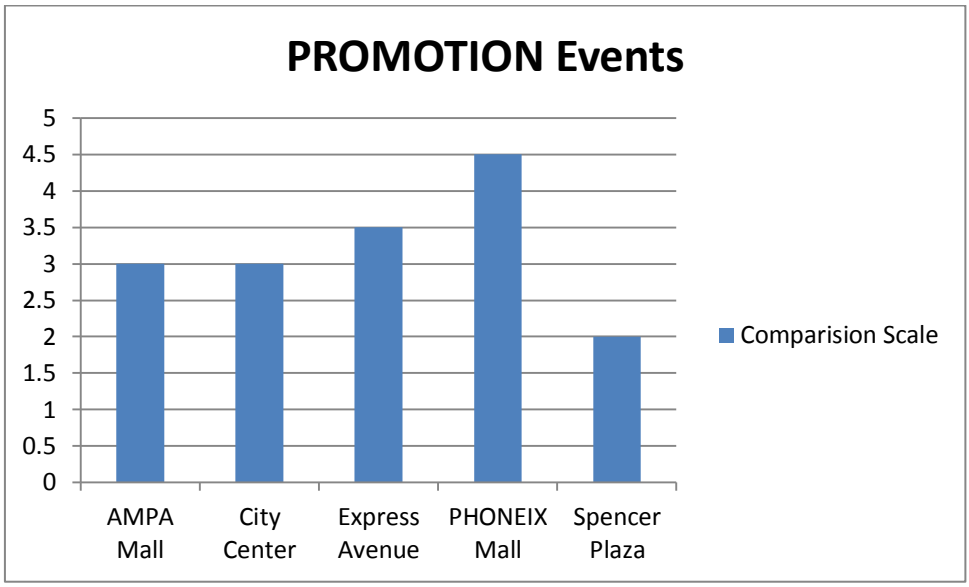
Number of people we observed purchasing in each mall was pictured comparatively.



4.6 Promotional activities

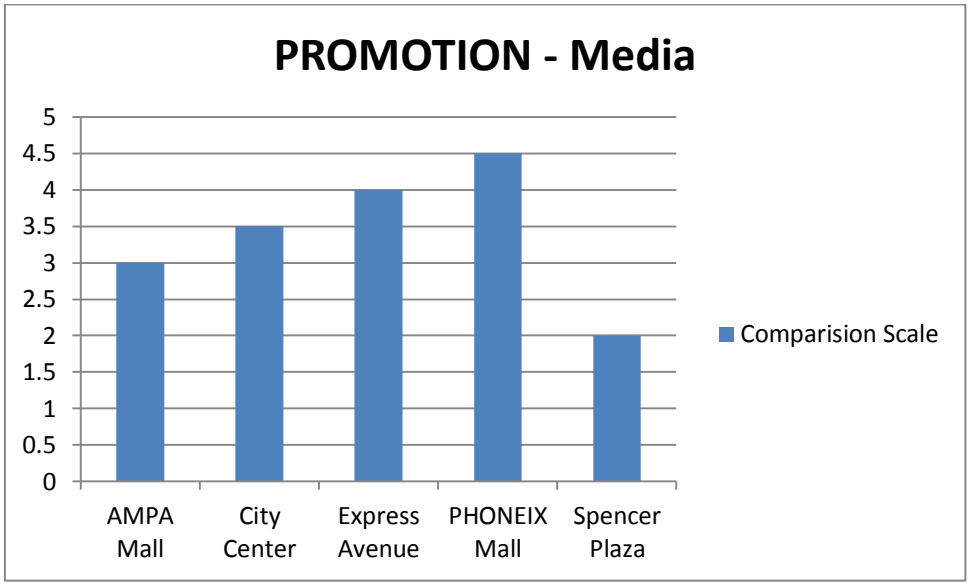
4.6.1 Events

Promotional events include the events they conduct in the ground floor during special days and festivals.



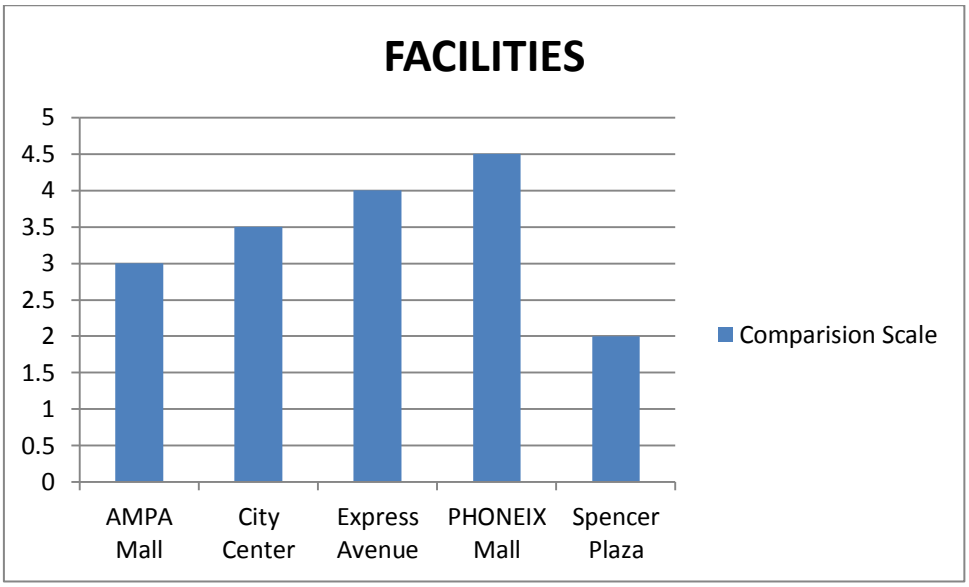
4.6.2 Media

Malls using various promotional channels were compared here. This includes using radio ads and announcing offers in their respective Facebook and Twitter pages.



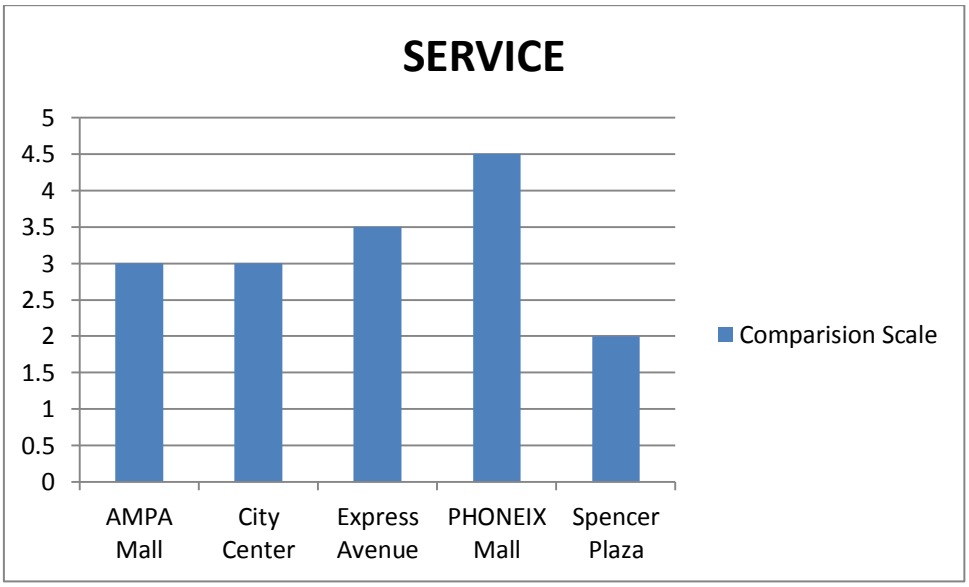
4.7 Facilities

Comparison based on facilities compared here includes the direction boards , mall map, frequent lift and escalator facilities and spacious parking lot.



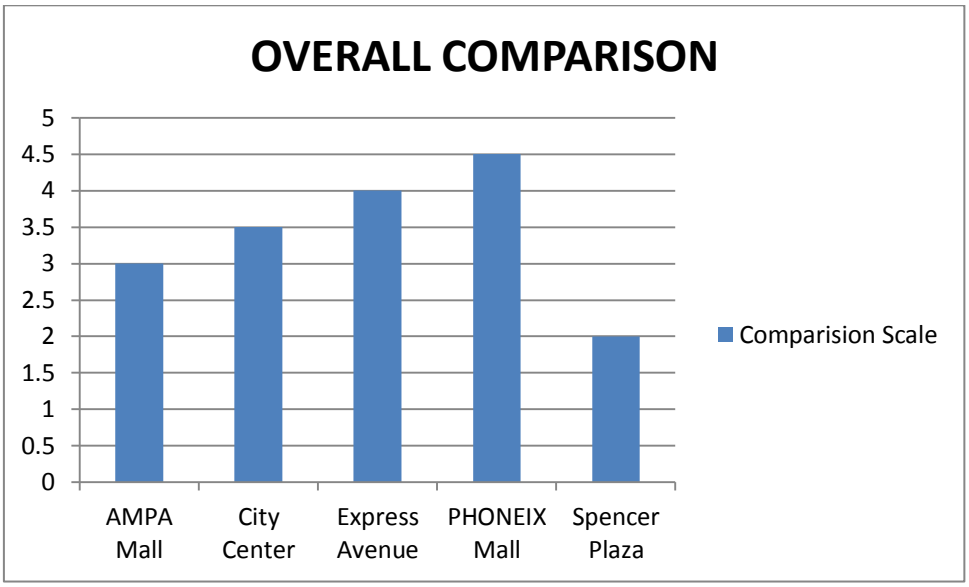
4.8 Service

Service here includes the way the shopkeepers treat the customers and window shoppers.



4.9 Overall comparison

Overall comparison is done based on all the factors stated above.



5. CONCLUSION

Thus we observed few of the most preferred malls of Chennai. One peculiar thing that we noticed it that malls are turning to be the picnic spot for many people where they can spend time roaming other than visiting for purchase. Since most of the above malls have all sort of shops starting from daily necessities, entertainment, food stalls to self-glooming no wonder malls can eat up a whole day for weekend spenders and shopaholic people.

6. DECLARATION

All the above observations were done on the given dates and time as specified and hence the actual comparison results regarding crowdedness, customers, promotional activities may change on long time comparison with statistical data and perception.